

Getting Started *with* Android App Development

Before starting Android app development, one has to get acquainted with the fundamentals. This article serves as a primer for app development.



Android is an open source Linux-based operating system for smartphones and tablets.

The Android platform allows users to develop and use their own applications in the Android framework. All the applications are available through the Android Play Store developed by Google.

All the Android apps are written in Java. Android runs on a Linux kernel. The VM used by Android to run apps is the Dalvik Virtual Machine, which is open source.

Setting up the Android development environment

System requirements

Operating system

- Windows XP (32-bit), Vista (32- or 64-bit), or Windows 7 (32- or 64-bit)
- Mac OS X 10.5.8 or later (x86 only)
- Linux

Development tools

- Java JDK6 or greater
- Android Studio

Downloads

JDK

- Download the appropriate version (i.e., 32-bit or 64-bit) for your system from the link <http://www.oracle.com/technetwork/java/javase/downloads/index.html>.
- Install JDK.

- Set the environment variables like PATH (i.e., `java_install_dir/bin`) and JAVA_HOME (i.e., `java_install_dir`) which refer to the directory that contains the Java and `javac` commands.
- If the Java environment variables are not set, then we have to set the path for the JDK while installing Android Studio.

Android Studio

- Download Android Studio from the link <https://developer.android.com/sdk/installing/studio.html>.
- Once the download is completed, follow the installation

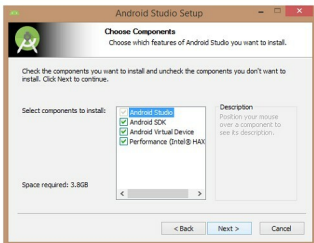


Figure 1: Setting up Android Studio